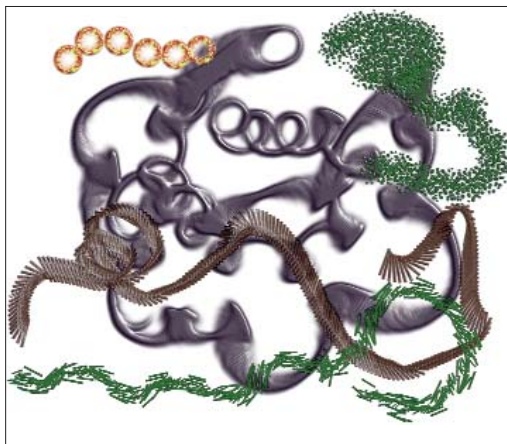


We would have liked some configurability with these filters, though—nearly all of them have their settings hard-coded into them



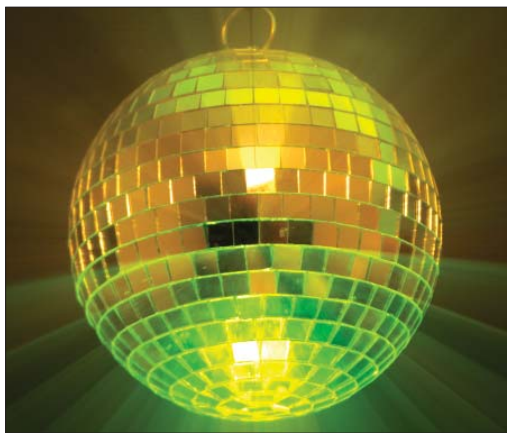
Create wacky paint effects with Deep Paint

reach a point when you can't undo as much as you thought. It's also not the easiest thing to learn, and will require that you invest some time exploring it.

Note: If you don't see Deep Paint in the Filters menu after installing (it will be under Right Hemisphere), copy DeepPaint.8bf from the Program Files\Right Hemisphere\Deep Paint\Plugins\PSplugin directory on your PC to your Plugins directory.

Luce

Luce is a simple, no-nonsense plugin to create volumetric lighting in your photograph. All you need to do is decide where to place the light source, and Luce will calculate all the necessary shadows and streaks to light up the scene. We recommended this for pictures of clouds and cityscapes—the results are startlingly good!



The disco ball comes to life with a few streaks of light, courtesy Luce

Topaz DeJPEG

If you've ever cursed at the way JPEG compression destroys detail in an image—especially at the edges of objects—then DeJPEG is for you. It compensates for JPEG compression losses, which makes it an indispensable tool for photo restoration (within reason, of course—there's only so much you can do for an image).

Freebie Collection by Flaming Pear

This is a collection of 33 free filters, ranging from basic channel-swapping effects to distortions—notably the Ornament effect, which will

straighten out any image with strong spherical distortion (the reflection of a party in a Christmas ornament, for example). The Solidify filter will fill out any transparent areas in a layer by approximating the colour from the nearest pixel, and the Tachyon filter inverts brightness levels without inverting colours for a pseudo-negative effect.

We would have liked some configurability with these filters, though—nearly all of them have their settings hard-coded into them.

Xero

Xero is a collection of 40 filters, each of which takes Photoshop's inherent filters one step further. We were also impressed by their sense of humour—in the Caravaggio filter, for instance, the parameters you'll be tweaking are Creativity, Exuberance, Attentiveness and Moodswing. Just the thing for an artistic filter—tweak the artistic temperament!



Xero packs some more interesting filters—like the Fritillary filter here

3D Shadow

Shadow effects in Photoshop have always been a sore point for some. Drop shadows are all very well, but when it comes to creating more advanced shadow effects, like the shadow of an object on a wall perpendicular to it, great pains must be taken. The 3D Shadow plugin lets you easily create and customise your shadows in any direction you choose.

Getting used to the plugin is a tad tricky, since it doesn't really offer you a 3D interface to create the shadows, favouring a bunch of sliders instead. However, once you get the hang of it, you'll have better control over those shadows.

Harry's Filters

The third collection of filters we're featuring here—and with good reason, too. Harry's Filters impressed us first with the amount of tweaking it allowed us for each effect. The number of options is quite dizzying, and even better, the 69 filters can all be accessed from the same dialog. There's even a Play button, which you can use to watch as your computer comes up with all the possible options for an effect.

PixelSampler

The TwistingPixels plugin comes with trial versions of PixelCreation, PixelPack and PixelPaper, and a free set of filters called PixelSampler, which lets you create some interestingly exaggerated movie-style effects. The StarLight filter, for